

Word family: **dive / dives / dived / dove / diving / diver**

Base word: dive

Forms: dives, dived, diving

Alternative past tense: dove (especially common in North American English)

Related form: diver

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / related person noun (相關人物名詞)

Your sentence:

> “So instead of **diving in**, I kept saying to myself, ‘I’ll read it when I have more time.’”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **dive in** means **to begin something eagerly or directly, especially without delaying or hesitating**.

In your sentence, the speaker did **not** immediately start reading the book.

繁體中文： **立即投入；直接開始；不再猶豫地開始做某事**

中文翻譯：

> “So instead of **diving in**, I kept saying to myself...”

「所以我沒有直接**投入去讀 / 立即開始**，反而一直對自己說.....」

Here:

dive in = 立即投入某項活動或工作

Important: this is a **phrasal/idiomatic extension** of **dive**. Under our normal database SOP, phrasal verbs are not automatically counted as core meanings, but because it appears in the target sentence, it needs to be mapped explicitly.

1. **dive = jump/fall headfirst into water (跳水) — 跳入水中；俯衝入水**

Meaning: To jump into water, usually headfirst and with the arms leading.

Practice 1

> “She **dived** into the pool.”

「她**跳進**泳池裡。」

Practice 2

> “He stood at the edge and **dived** into the sea.”

「他站在邊緣，然後**跳入海中**。」

dive = 以頭部或上半身先進入水中的方式跳入水裡

Common:

* dive into the pool

* dive into the sea

* dive from a platform

2. **dive = swim underwater / go beneath the surface (水下活動) — 潛水 ; 下潛**

Dive can also mean to go underwater, especially deliberately.

Practice 3

> “The whale **dived** beneath the surface.”

「鯨魚**潛入**水面下。」

Practice 4

> “They went **diving** near the reef.”

「他們到珊瑚礁附近**潛水**。」

dive = 進入水面以下並在水中活動

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the focus is not the jump itself; it is **submerging and moving underwater**.

For strict counting, these can remain under one broad physical-water branch if desired.

3. **dive = move steeply downward (俯衝 / 急降) — 俯衝 ; 急速下降**

Birds, aircraft, people, or objects can **dive** when they move sharply downward.

Practice 5

> “The bird ****dived**** toward the water.”

「那隻鳥朝水面****俯衝****下去。」

Practice 6

> “The plane suddenly began to ****dive****.”

「飛機突然開始****急速下降 / 俯衝****。」

****dive = 從較高位置快速而陡峭地向下移動****

This is a major extension from the physical movement of entering water.

4. ****dive = fall sharply in amount/value (數字 / 價格) — 暴跌 ; 急降****

Prices, sales, profits, temperatures, ratings, etc. can ****dive****.

Practice 7

> “Sales ****dived**** after the announcement.”

「消息公布後，銷售額****急跌****。」

Practice 8

> “Temperatures ****dived**** overnight.”

「氣溫在一夜之間****急降****。」

****dive = 數字、價格、水平或數量突然大幅下降****

This is a major figurative sense.

Common:

- * prices dive
- * shares dive
- * sales dive
- * temperatures dive

5. **dive = move suddenly to catch/avoid something (撲 / 猛衝) — 猛撲 ; 迅速撲向**

A person can **dive** in a sudden, forceful movement, often to catch something, avoid danger, or reach safety.

Practice 9

> “The goalkeeper **dived** to his left.”

「守門員向左邊**飛身撲救**。」

Practice 10

> “She **dived** behind the wall when she heard the noise.”

「她聽到聲音後迅速**撲到牆後躲避**。」

dive = 突然而快速地向某個方向撲去

This is related to the physical downward/forward movement branch.

6. **dive = deliberately fall in sport (體育) — 假摔**

In some sports, especially football/soccer, **dive** can mean deliberately falling to make it appear that another player fouled you.

Practice 11

> “The referee thought the player had **dived**.”

「球證認為那名球員是**假摔**。」

Practice 12

> “He was criticized for **diving** in the penalty area.”

「他因在禁區內**假摔**而受到批評。」

dive = 在體育比賽中故意倒地，製造被犯規的假象

This is a distinct modern sports sense.

7. **dive in = begin eagerly/directly (片語) — 馬上投入；直接開始**

This is the exact construction used in your passage.

Practice 13 — Original

> “Instead of **diving in**, I kept putting the book off.”

「我沒有立即**投入去讀**，反而一直拖延。」

Practice 14

> “Once everyone arrived, we **dived in** and started planning.”

「大家到齊後，我們便立即**投入**規劃工作。」

Practice 15

> “Don’t overthink it—just **dive in**.”

「別想太多，直接**開始做吧**。」

dive in = 不再猶豫，立即積極投入某件事

This is a fixed phrasal/idiomatic construction rather than a new core sense of bare **dive**.

8. **dive into = become deeply involved in something (片語) — 深入投入；鑽研**

A closely related construction is:

> **dive into something**

meaning to begin examining, studying, or working on something with energy and focus.

Practice 16

> “She **dived into** the research.”

「她全心**投入研究**。」

Practice 17

> “The book **dives into** the history of the subject.”

「這本書**深入探討**這個主題的歷史。」

****dive into = 積極深入某個主題、活動或工作****

Again, this is a phrasal extension.

9. ****dive = a dive/jump into water (名詞) — 跳水；潛水動作****

As a noun, ****dive**** can mean an act of diving.

Practice 18

> “He made a clean ****dive**** into the pool.”

「他乾淨俐落地完成了一次****跳水****。」

Practice 19

> “The diver made a deep ****dive****.”

「潛水員進行了一次深度****潛水****。」

****a dive = 一次跳水、下潛或俯衝動作****

10. ****dive = cheap/run-down bar or place (口語) — 破舊廉價的酒吧 / 場所****

In informal English, ****a dive**** can mean a shabby, low-quality bar, restaurant, hotel, or similar place.

Practice 20

> “The bar looks like a ****dive****, but the food is excellent.”

「那間酒吧看起來很****破舊廉價****，但食物很好。」

Practice 21

> “They stayed in a cheap ****dive**** near the station.”

「他們住在車站附近一間便宜又****破舊的旅館****。」

****a dive = 廉價、破舊、品質不高的酒吧、旅館或類似場所****

This is a genuinely distinct noun sense.

Related form: ****diver****

A ****diver**** is someone who dives.

Practice 22

> “The ****diver**** disappeared beneath the surface.”

「那名****潛水員 / 跳水者****消失在水面下。」

Depending on context:

* ****scuba diver**** = 水肺潛水員

* ****competitive diver**** = 跳水運動員

Important distinction: ****dive vs jump****

****jump****

means push yourself off the ground/surface into the air.

****dive****

usually suggests:

* headfirst movement

* downward movement

* entering water

* sudden steep movement

> jump into the pool

can be feet-first.

> dive into the pool

typically suggests headfirst entry.

Important distinction: ****dive vs swim****

****swim****

= move through water

****dive****

= go below the surface or enter water, often downward

You can swim without diving.

Important distinction: ****dive vs sink****

****dive****

is usually deliberate or rapid movement downward.

****sink****

means gradually or naturally move downward because of weight, loss of support, etc.

> submarine dives

> ship sinks

Different control and imagery.

Important distinction: ****dive vs plunge****

****plunge****

often suggests sudden, forceful, dramatic downward movement.

****dive****

is more neutral and often more controlled.

Both can be used figuratively:

> prices plunged

> prices dived

****Plunge**** often sounds slightly more dramatic.

Important distinction: ****dive vs drop****

For numbers:

****drop****

= decrease

****dive****

= decrease suddenly and sharply

> prices dropped 2%

neutral.

> prices dived

strong dramatic decrease.

Important distinction: ****dive in vs start****

****start****

simply means begin.

****dive in****

adds the idea of:

* immediate action

* enthusiasm

* little hesitation

> "I started reading."

neutral.

> “I dived in.”

= I began energetically and directly.

Grammar and spelling note: ****dived vs dove****

Both are accepted past-tense forms of ****dive****.

****dived****

is widely used across varieties of English.

****dove****

is especially common in North American English.

Examples:

> “She dived into the pool.”

> “She dove into the pool.”

Both are standard.

The past participle is usually:

> ****dived****

especially in formal edited English:

> “He has dived there before.”

Countability note

As a noun, ****dive**** is countable:

> a dive

> two dives

This applies to:

* a jump into water

* a period of underwater descent

* a shabby place

Context distinguishes them.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **dive**
* **dives**
* **dived**
* **dove**
* **diving**
* **diver**

Useful constructions include:

* dive into water
* dive beneath the surface
* prices dive
* dive for the ball
* dive in
* dive into a subject
* a dive
* a cheap dive

The key second-pass curation point is that **dive in / dive into** should be explicitly mapped here because it is essential to the exact target sentence, even though the normal SOP excludes phrasal verbs by default unless the target context requires them.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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dive — enter water	以頭部或上半身先進入水中的方式跳入水裡
dive — go underwater	潛入水面以下並在水中活動
dive — move steeply downward	從較高位置快速、陡峭地向下移動；俯衝 / 急降
dive — numbers/value	價格、數量、水平等突然大幅下降
dive — sudden physical movement	突然而快速地向某方向撲去
dive — sport	故意倒地製造被犯規假象；假摔
dive in	不再猶豫，立即積極投入某事
dive into	深入投入、研究或處理某件事
a dive	一次跳水 / 下潛；亦可指破舊廉價的場所

| ****diver****

| 跳水者 / 潛水員

|

For your original sentence

> “So instead of ****diving in****, I kept saying to myself, ‘I’ll read it when I have more time.’”

The exact meaning is:

****diving in = 不再拖延或猶豫，而是立即開始並投入閱讀****

So:

> ****instead of diving in****

= ****沒有直接投入去讀 / 沒有馬上開始****

For your database, I would count ****5 genuinely useful core meanings**** for bare ****dive****:

1. ****enter/go underwater****
2. ****move sharply downward****
3. ****fall sharply in value/amount****
4. ****make a sudden physical lunge****
5. ****sports: deliberately fall / fake a foul****

I would keep ****dive in / dive into**** as essential phrasal extensions, and keep noun ****a dive = shabby place**** as a separate lexical noun sense rather than merge it with the physical movement meanings.